PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Threat Detection Analyst | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR)

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Threat Detection Analyst with over five years of experience engineering and operating detection capabilities across Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms. I have designed and tuned detection rules across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender at scale, and I specialise in threat hunting, alert triage, and behavioural detection development mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I bring a disciplined, analyst-led mindset and have served as a technical escalation point for security operations, driving measurable improvements in detection fidelity and analyst workflow efficiency within high-pressure, global environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Threat Detection Engineering:** Detection rule design and tuning across SIEM, EDR and SOAR; use-case development; alert fidelity improvement
- **SIEM Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)), Splunk (Search Processing Language (SPL))
- **EDR and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Falcon EDR, Falcon Insight, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **SOAR Automation:** Automated playbook engineering, incident response automation, alert enrichment and triage workflows
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hunting using KQL, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, and MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs)
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 framework, investigation, containment, eradication, recovery, lessons-learned review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Certifications:** CISSP (exceeds GCDA, GCIH, AZ-500 requirements); CompTIA Security+; Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Author and tune detection rules across SIEM, EDR, and SOAR platforms including CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Defender XDR, maintaining high-fidelity alert coverage across an 8,000-user environment.
- Serve as the senior escalation point for complex security incidents, performing deep-dive investigation of endpoint, identity, network, and cloud telemetry to determine root cause and scope.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, mapping adversarial behaviours to MITRE ATT&CK and introducing new detection hypotheses based on threat intelligence feeds.
- Engineer SOAR playbooks to automate alert triage, enrichment, and initial containment steps, reducing analyst manual effort and accelerating response timelines.
- Lead incident response activities in accordance with NIST SP 800-61, coordinating investigation, containment, eradication, and post-incident review with internal teams and stakeholders.

- Manage the Vulnerability Management lifecycle using Tenable.io, Nessus, and Pentera BAS, correlating findings with active threat intelligence to prioritise remediation efforts.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Performed daily alert triage and investigation across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon SIEM, classifying true positives and escalating confirmed incidents in line with defined runbooks.
- Developed and refined KQL detection queries in Microsoft Sentinel and SPL searches in Splunk to improve signal-to-noise ratios and reduce false-positive volumes.
- Supported the rollout and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, contributing to detection rule tuning and policy hardening across managed endpoints.
- Performed threat hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying credential harvesting, lateral movement, and persistence mechanisms mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Authored incident response runbooks, threat detection playbooks, and analyst operational guides, improving Security Operations Centre (SOC) maturity and consistency of response.
- Assisted with Cyber Essentials Plus certification, gathering evidence and remediating gaps across endpoint, identity, and perimeter controls.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)
IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Supported security monitoring and alert management within a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, contributing to incident triage and security tooling administration.
- Assisted with endpoint protection deployment, firewall policy management, and access control reviews, reducing exposure across cloud and on-premise infrastructure.
- Participated in security quality assurance processes, documenting findings and supporting remediation tracking in line with internal compliance requirements.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a threat-hunting programme aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively identifying attacker behaviours including credential abuse, lateral movement, and persistence across both endpoint and identity planes.
- Engineered SOAR automation playbooks that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) by automating initial triage, alert enrichment, and containment steps across common incident types.
- Designed and deployed custom SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using Kusto Query Language (KQL), significantly improving true-positive rates and reducing alert fatigue for the security operations team.
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across approximately 8,000 users, delivering full EDR coverage and improving endpoint visibility across the university estate.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification by coordinating cross-team remediation and providing technical evidence across all control categories.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate